

HS 301: Policy Analysis and Advocacy Skills

Course Code	HS 301
Course Name	Policy Analysis and Advocacy Skills
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the faculty member
Intended for	B.Tech
Distribution	Elective
One-time approval	2nd Adhoc Senate (May 2012), in the B.Tech HSS core (Humanities and Social Sciences streams) curriculum; recommended by the 14th BoA (Sep 2016)

Course Contents

- Logical Thinking, the Enthymeme; standard fallacies
- Common topoi
- Features of the Forensic Debate: The Proposition, Affirmative and Negative Sides, Presumption and Burden of Proof, Prima Facie Case, Justification for a Program of Action, Disparity and Stock Issue Analysis, Techniques of Gathering Evidence from various sources including newspapers, journals, periodicals, government documents, of using citizens empowerment provisos to elicit information etc.
- Standard Speaker Formats, Parliamentary Debates and Resolutions, Techniques of Cross- Examination, Academic Debate, Debate Flow Sheet and Debate Critique.

Readings

1. Select Excerpts from **The Hansard**, Edited verbatim report of the proceedings of the House of Commons and the House of Lords.
2. Select Newspaper Articles besides select essays from journals like Resurgence, Down to Earth, back numbers of the now defunct MANAS etc.
3. J. Michael Sproule, **Argument: Language and its Influence**, McGraw-Hill, 1980: Chapters ten & eleven only.

Readings

1. Eugene Bardach, **A Practical Guide for Policy Analysis: The Eight Fold Guide to More Effective Problem Solving**, CQ Press Washington 2005.
2. George M. Guess & Paul G. Farnham, **Cases in Public Policy Analysis**, Georgetown University Press, 2000.
3. Gerald Miller, **Handbook of Public Policy Analysis**, Taylor & Francis, 2007.

Social Competence

Here again, you have a choice of three courses.

- **Principles of Economics:** How do nations generate wealth? How does the state regulate its distribution to ensure reasonable standards of living for all? What is the impact of mans economic pursuit on environment and ecology? Is there a link between the prosperity of the developed nations and the massive poverty elsewhere? The course examines the economic principles that govern daily life; it traces the rise of consumerism from the barter economy of early societies to the casino capitalism of today. Field trips and surveys in the Himachal region shall complement your understanding.
- **Understanding Society:** The course invites students to examine the unfolding forms and modes of human collective living from ancient to modern times. Students will also study the institutional framework as well as living conditions of humans across distinctive historical periods. Besides, they will investigate the impact of modern life in its various forms on the mind, on marriage, on family and its breakdown and of its significance for the future. They will attempt to comprehend diverse levels of stress in modern life and the solutions attempted, also economic factors and their psycho-social impact. Field trips to various tribal communities in Himachal Pradesh complement students understanding.
- **Political Science:** Why does Aristotle describe Politics as the Master Science? Just think how difficult it is for us to maintain peace and harmony in our homes! How much more difficult would it then be to keep a country of 1.2 billion to live in peace with one another? How are we to understand Aristotles paradoxical assertion that the evil in man makes society necessary but it is the good in man that makes society function. Field trips to local communities in the neighborhood make for understanding firsthand key issues in politics, law and governance.